VELLUM PRESS

HOME FITNESS

Floor & Form

Strength, no equipment



A DIGITAL GUIDE

Floor & Form

Floor & Form is strength training for a room with a floor. No bands, no machines. You will learn three sessions, a warm-up, and an eight-week progression.

Get cleared for general exercise if you are injured, pregnant, newly postpartum, or managing a condition that changes what you can do. Sharp pain is a stop, not a cue.

> Health disclaimer. This guide is education for adults. It is not medical advice, diagnosis, or a treatment plan, and it does not replace a physician, registered dietitian, or qualified coach. Bodies differ. Talk with a licensed clinician before you change how you eat or train, especially if you are pregnant, under 18, injured, managing an illness, or have a history of disordered eating. Stop and seek care for chest pain, fainting, or pain that is sharp, swelling, or unexplained. If you are in crisis in the United States, call or text 988.

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01

How to use this guide

Train two days a week for the first two weeks even if you feel ambitious. Add the third day only when you can walk downstairs the next morning without a new complaint. Sessions are full body. You do not need a split.

Leave one or two reps in reserve. The last rep should be clean. If your back rounds, your knees cave, or you hold your breath until you are dizzy, the set was too hard. Make it easier and continue.

- Clear a space the size of a yoga mat.
- A sturdy table is optional for rows. Skip the row if the table is not sturdy.
- Train in shoes or barefoot, the same way each week, so you can compare.
- Write the session down. Memory flatters you.

02

Principles before sweat

You are practicing patterns: squat, hinge, push, pull, and a brace through the middle. Bodyweight work gets harder by slowing the lowering, adding a pause, or moving to a harder angle. It does not get harder by thrashing.

Breathe out on the effort. If a set makes you gasp, rest longer. Rest is part of the session. Sixty to ninety seconds between sets is enough for this program.

Pattern	Easier	Standard	Harder
Squat	Sit to a high chair	Sit to a low chair	Slower lower, pause
Hinge	Hands on a counter	Good morning, hands at chest	Single-leg with support
Push	Wall	Counter or knee	Floor push-up
Pull	Towel row standing	Table row	Slower lower
Brace	Dead bug, short lever	Dead bug, long lever	Side plank

03

Warm-up and positions

Five minutes. Do not skip it because you are busy. Cold joints are how a short program becomes a week off.

- [ ] 30 seconds of easy marching.
- [ ] 10 slow squats to a chair.
- [ ] 10 hip hinges with hands on thighs.
- [ ] 8 wall push-ups.
- [ ] Open and close the hips: 5 gentle circles each direction.
- [ ] 2 breaths in a tall standing position, ribs stacked over pelvis.

The tall position is the one you return to between exercises. Ribs down, feet planted, jaw unclenched. If you cannot find it, you are rushing.

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04

Sessions A, B, and C

Session A emphasizes squat and push. Session B emphasizes hinge and pull. Session C is a lighter mix for the week you add a third day. Do A and B first. Rest at least one day between A and B.

Session	Order	Sets x reps	Rest
A	Chair squat	3 x 8	75 sec
A	Push-up variation	3 x 6 to 10	75 sec
A	Table row or towel row	3 x 8	75 sec
A	Dead bug	2 x 6 each side	45 sec
B	Hinge	3 x 8	75 sec
B	Row	3 x 8	75 sec
B	Push-up variation	2 x 8	75 sec
B	Side plank	2 x 20 sec each	45 sec
C	Squat	2 x 8	60 sec
C	Hinge	2 x 8	60 sec
C	Push	2 x 8	60 sec
C	Dead bug	2 x 5 each	45 sec

> **Try this.** If you only have twenty minutes, do two sets of the first three movements and leave. A short session counts. A skipped week does not get paid back by a heroic Sunday.

05

The eight-week progression

Weeks 1 and 2: learn the easier variation and hit the reps cleanly. Weeks 3 and 4: move toward the standard variation or add a one-second pause at the bottom. Weeks 5 and 6: slow the lowering to a three-count. Weeks 7 and 8: add the third session if recovery is good, or add one rep to each set if it is not.

Weeks	Change	Days	Stop if
1 to 2	Learn positions	2	Form breaks
3 to 4	Harder angle or a pause	2	Joint pain
5 to 6	Three-count lower	2	You dread the session
7 to 8	Third day or one more rep	2 or 3	Sleep or pain worsens

Do not add a variation and a slower tempo in the same week. One change. Write it at the top of the log so you remember what you are testing.

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06

Form cues when you train alone

Squat: sit back to the chair, knees track over mid-foot, chest stays proud enough that you can take a breath at the bottom. Stand by pushing the floor away.

Hinge: soft knees, push the hips back, spine stays long. You should feel the back of the thighs, not a pinch in the low back. Push: body in a line from head to knees or heels, elbows about 45 degrees from your sides. Pull: start the row by pulling the shoulder blades toward each other, then the elbows.

- Film one set from the side every other week. Watch it once.
- If the film and the feeling disagree, believe the film.
- Pain on one side only is a reason to regress, not to match the other side's reps.
- Hold the brace without holding your breath.

07

Soreness, joints, and rest

Muscle soreness that is dull and spread out is ordinary in weeks 1 and 2. Joint pain that is sharp, local, or still there after you warm up is not something to train through. Skip the movement that causes it. Keep the others.

Feeling	Likely meaning	Action
Dull muscle ache	New work	Keep the plan, maybe fewer sets
Sharp joint pain	Too much load or angle	Regress or stop that move
Pain at night	Not simple soreness	Stop and get it checked
Dizzy during a set	Breath or blood pressure	Sit down. End the session

> Chest pain, fainting, or sudden shortness of breath is an emergency, not a line in a training log. Seek urgent care.

08

A short conditioning finisher

After the last set, optional: four minutes of easy work. Forty seconds of marching or step-ups on the bottom stair, twenty seconds of rest, repeated four times. You should be able to speak in short sentences. If you cannot, you are going too hard and you will start skipping the strength.

The finisher is not the program. Strength is the program. On a week when time is short, delete the finisher first.

- [ ] Session letter written down.
- [ ] Variation used for push and squat.
- [ ] Reps completed, honestly.
- [ ] Any pain, and which movement.
- [ ] Next session's single change, or none.

> **Try this.** Lay out the space the night before if mornings are when you train. The decision is smaller when the floor is already clear.

09

A worked example

C had not trained in years and could not do a floor push-up. Week 1 was wall push-ups, a high chair squat, and a hinge with hands on the counter. The sessions felt too easy and too awkward. Both were correct. The film from the side showed his back rounding on the hinge, so week 2 stayed at the counter.

Week 4 he moved push-ups to the kitchen counter and squats to a lower chair. Soreness was dull and in the legs. A sharp pinch in the right shoulder on the floor push-up, which he tested once, sent him back to the counter. He did not 'push through.' The program still counted.

Week 6 he slowed the lowering to a three-count. Reps dropped. That was the progression, not a failure. Week 8 he added session C because sleep was fine and stairs felt ordinary. He still cannot do a perfect floor push-up. He can do eight clean counter push-ups and a squat he trusts. That is the result the log was for.

If your week does not look like this one, do not force the resemblance. Copy the structure: a baseline, one change at a time, a written review, and a stop when the tool is the wrong tool. The names above are teaching composites, not testimonials and not promises.

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10

Field pages

Log the session you did, not the session you imagined. Variation matters more than a round number of reps.

Session log

Date	A/B/C	Squat variation	Push variation	Pull variation	Pain?
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					

Eight-week change

Weeks	The one change I am testing	Did form hold?
1 to 2		
3 to 4		
5 to 6		
7 to 8		

- ☐ Warm-up happened.
- ☐ Last reps were clean.
- ☐ I left a rep in reserve.
- ☐ Sharp pain stopped the movement.
- ☐ Next session is already on the calendar.

11

Thirty-day log

This log is the part you write. Print it. A guide you only read is a brochure. Thirty lines is a month, and a month is long enough to see whether the method fits.

Days 1 to 15

Day	Session	Main lift	Reps	Pain	Note
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					
13					
14					
15					

Do not backfill a day you forgot. Leave it blank. A blank line is more useful next month than a number you invented. The lines are tall enough to write in, not just to type a checkmark.

Days 16 to 30

Day	Session	Main lift	Reps	Pain	Note
16					

Day	Session	Main lift	Reps	Pain	Note
17					
18					
19					
20					
21					
22					
23					
24					
25					
26					
27					
28					
29					
30					

Weekly notes

Week	What repeated	What I will change
1		
2		
3		
4		

Week	What repeated	What I will change
5		

Open notes

	Write in the lines

End of the month

Question	Your answer
What actually repeated?	
What did I abandon, and should it stay abandoned?	
What is the one change for next month?	

Question	Your answer
Do I need a person, not a PDF?	
Where is the file saved on my own device?	

- ☐ I can find this PDF without the download link.
- ☐ The license is mine. I have not posted the file.
- ☐ Next month's first action is written in one sentence.
- ☐ If the guide was the wrong tool, I know what I will do instead.

A last word

Use the pages that match the week you are actually having. Print a worksheet if paper helps you tell the truth. Put the file somewhere you can find it. And if a chapter tells you to talk to a licensed professional, that instruction outranks the rest of the PDF.